Skills Summary

Subtracting Within 10 on a Number Path

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

A number path is a row of squares, one for each number. Put a finger on a square and hop: left takes away, right adds on. Say the number of the square you land on, never the one you start from.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

1. Hop back to take away

How to do it: start on the *first* number. Hop one square to the **left** for each one you take away. The square you land on is the answer.

Say the start number *before* you hop, then count each hop: for $7 - 3$ say "seven" first, then "one, two, three" as you hop.

Example: $7 - 3$
Step 1. Taking away means going down, so start on the bigger number and hop to the left.
Step 2. Start on 7. Hop to 6, hop to 5, hop to 4. That is three hops.
$7 - 3 = \mathbf{4}$

Try it: $9 - 2$

check: **7**

2. Hop up when the numbers are close

How to do it: start on the *smaller* number and hop to the **right** until you reach the bigger one. **Count the hops** — the number of hops is the answer.

Use this when the two numbers are near each other, like $9 - 7$ or $10 - 8$. Fewer hops means fewer chances to miscount.

Example: $8 - 6$
Step 1. 6 and 8 are close together, so hopping up from 6 is quicker than hopping back six times.
Step 2. Start on 6. Hop to 7, hop to 8. Stop. That is two hops.
$8 - 6 = \mathbf{2}$

Try it: $10 - 7$

check: **3**

3. Find the missing number

How to do it: when the middle number is missing, you know where you start and where you land. Put one finger on each square and **count the hops between them**. That count is the missing number.

Example: $6 - \_\_\_\_ = 2$

Step 1. The start and the landing square are both given, so the missing part is how far apart they are.

Step 2. One finger on 6, one on 2. Hop from 6 to 5, 4, 3, 2: four hops.

$6 - \mathbf{4} = 2$

Try it: $8 - \_\_\_\_ = 5$

check: **3**

(!) Watch out: do not count the starting square as a hop. For $6 - 2$, say "six" on the square and then hop twice — landing on 4, not 5.